

Lesson 1 Guide · Staying Safe Online

Module SC103 · Digital Literacy & Cyber Safety · Social Coding SA

Your accounts

Use a different password for every important account — if one site leaks, the others stay safe. Longer beats complicated: three random words ("giraffe-taxi-winter") beat "P@ss1". Never share a password, even with a friend, and turn on two-step verification for WhatsApp and email.

Spotting scams & phishing

Warning signs: urgency ("act NOW"), prizes you never entered, requests for your PIN or password, and links that almost match a real name (fnb-secure-login.co). Banks and schools never ask for your password by message. When unsure: don't click — go to the real site yourself.

Your information

Before posting, ask: would I be okay with a stranger, a teacher, and a future employer seeing this? Location, school name, ID numbers and daily routines are valuable to the wrong people. What goes online can be screenshotted — deleting doesn't un-share.

Discussion for class

1. A message says you've won data — click the link to claim. What do you check first? 2. A friend asks for your password "just to check something" — what do you say? 3. Which of your accounts share one password today, and which will you fix this week?